The Collaborative Discussion Toolkit Is Moving to Our Website

Our free group-discussion activities are coming to one home on our website

The Interactivity Foundation (IF) is moving its Collaborative Discussion Toolkit to our website. The Toolkit is a free collection of 46 activities from our Collaborative Discussion Project, organized in five modules: Introduction, Creative, Critical, Culturally Responsive, and Civic Collaboration. Today, the Toolkit lives on its own separate website. In October, we decided to bring it to our main website, so all our resources are in one place and the Toolkit is easier to keep up to date.

Nothing changes for you yet. The Toolkit stays available where it is today, and we will share the new address here when the activities are ready.

How the move works

A changed step time, a missing journal prompt, or one added word in a facilitation step can change how an activity runs, so every word matters. A team of students from Carnegie Mellon University's Heinz College built a tool that copies each activity, with its printable PDF and images, into one consistent page layout. The wording is copied by fixed computer code, not retyped by AI, so it stays exactly as written.

Each activity will be checked against the original. If anything differs, the activity will be held back and our staff will see exactly what changed. Activities will arrive as drafts, and nothing will appear on our website until our staff have reviewed an activity and chosen to publish it. For new and revised activities, our staff will get a fill-in template, a review checklist, and a step-by-step guide, so every activity follows the same layout.

Tested with care

Before running the tool on the real Toolkit, the team tested it on 46 invented activities built to look like the real ones. Every activity was copied word for word. With all of its safety checks switched on, the tool caught all nine problems the team planted on purpose, such as a changed step time, a dropped step, or one inserted "not," before any of them could reach a draft. In separate tests on a practice website, the tool's account could create drafts, but the website refused to let it publish.

What comes next

Next, the team will run the tool on the real Toolkit and place the drafts on a test copy of our website before anything goes near the live site.

With thanks

With thanks to Nibedita Biswal, Like Cui, Joshua Kalakoti, Yinfeng Liu, and Letu Wang, students at Carnegie Mellon University's Heinz College, who designed and built this tool as part of their Fall 2026 coursework.